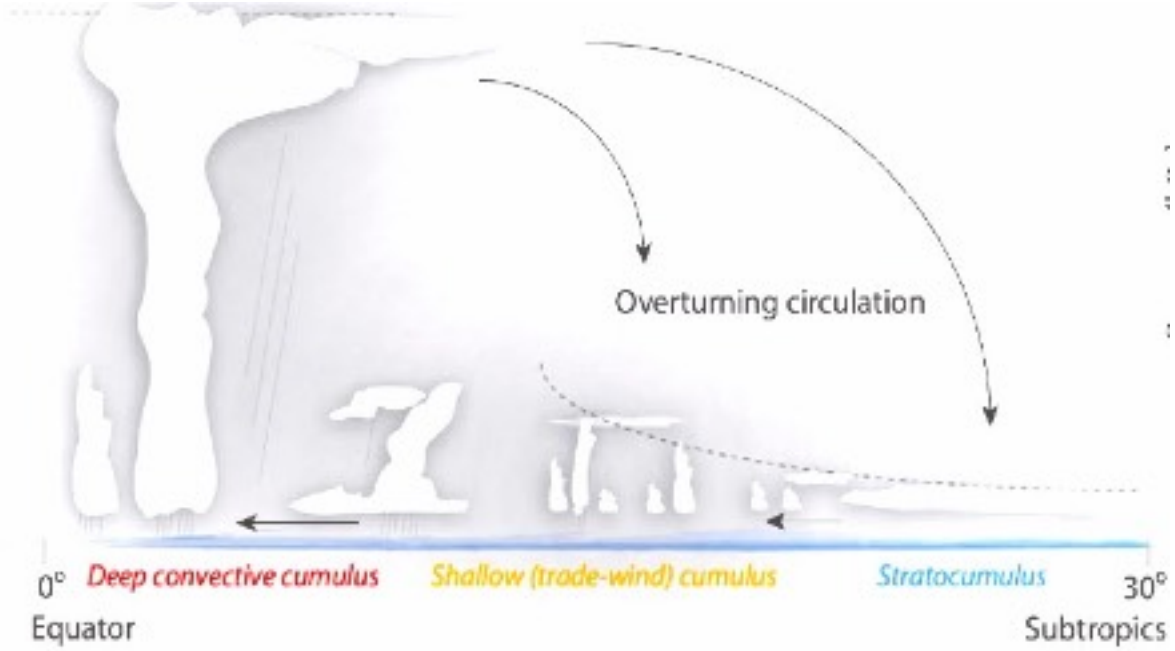
We focus a lot on tropical clouds: why?

- Vis à vis radiation:
  - differentiating low and high cloud physics and feedbacks is important
- Importance of tropical clouds:
  - There are a lot of them!
  - Deep convection
  - Heavy precipitation
  - Large scale circulations



Nuijens & Jakob, *Clouds and Climate* (2020) (& Stevens & Hohenegger :))

Tropical clouds: cont.

- Tropical clouds: uncertain *and* high-impact
  - Earth's energy budget (i.e., radiation)
  - Impacts **climate sensitivity**

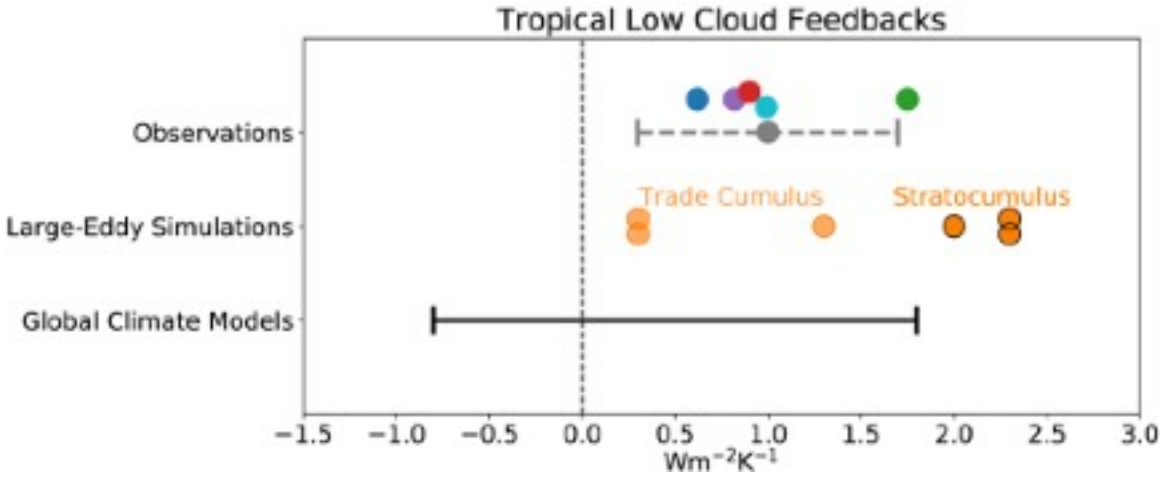
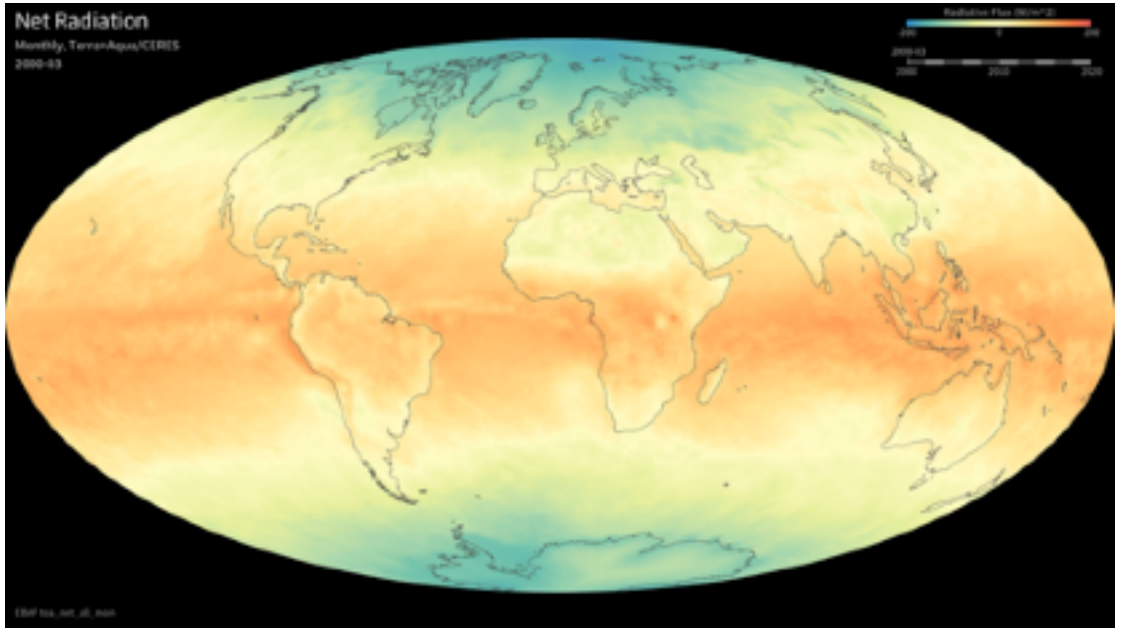


Fig. 6 from Sherwood et al. (2020) *An Assessment of Earth's Climate Sensitivity Using Multiple Lines of Evidence*



Monthly net TOA radiation from NASA's Goddard Space Flight Center satellite data